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ARTICLE

Israel At 78: The Growing Call To Rebuild The Third Temple





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למטפלים: משחק לפיתוח
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BY PNW STAFF MAY 18, 2026

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The banners waving through Jerusalem this year were not only blue-and-white Israeli flags. During the recent Jerusalem Day celebrations, another symbol appeared again and again among crowds marching through the Old City: images of a future Third Temple standing upon the Temple Mount. For some, it was political theater. For others, it was a declaration of destiny.

The timing felt significant to many Israelis. This year marked Israel's 78th birthday as a modern state -- a milestone many religious Jews increasingly connect to what they see as the gradual restoration of biblical Israel after nearly 2,000 years of exile. To them, the rebirth of the nation in 1948 was never the end of the story. Jerusalem's reunification in 1967 was another step. And now, growing numbers believe the next phase may center around the Temple Mount itself.

What was once considered a fringe religious aspiration inside Israel is steadily moving closer to the mainstream. The idea of rebuilding a Third Temple in Jerusalem -- on the very site where the First and Second Temples once stood -- is no longer confined to obscure activist circles. It is now openly discussed by rabbis, politicians, members of the military, and growing segments of Israeli society still reeling from the trauma of October 7.

And for Christians who study Bible prophecy, those developments are impossible to ignore.

AUTISM OR HIGH IQ?



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His words were not accidental.

The Temple Mount remains the single most explosive religious site on earth. Jews regard it as the location of the First and Second Temples. Muslims revere it as the site of the Dome of the Rock and Al-Aqsa Mosque. Since Israel captured the Old City during the 1967 Six-Day War, a fragile arrangement has remained in place in which Israel controls security while the Jordanian-backed Islamic Waqf oversees daily administration.

But men like Ben-Gvir increasingly argue that arrangement should end.

His decision to raise the Israeli flag on the mount during Jerusalem Day celebrations sent a message not only to Israelis, but to the entire Middle East: there is a growing movement inside Israel that no longer wishes to merely visit the Temple Mount -- it wants to reclaim it.

That movement has been growing for years.

Organizations like the Temple Institute have spent decades preparing for the possibility of a future temple. Temple vessels have been recreated. Priestly garments have been sewn. Training for ritual practices has resumed. Even discussions surrounding red heifers and purification rituals -- once dismissed as symbolic religious curiosities -- are now taken seriously by many observant Jews.

The preparations go even further. The Temple Institute has also completed a massive golden menorah intended for a future temple and placed it on public display overlooking the Western Wall. The organization has also worked extensively on training men believed to be descendants of the biblical priesthood for future temple service and has even developed architectural plans and educational models envisioning how a Third Temple could function in modern Jerusalem. What once sounded symbolic increasingly appears methodical and deliberate.

The movement no longer feels theoretical.



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October 7 changed Israel profoundly. The Hamas massacre shattered assumptions about security, peace, and coexistence. In its aftermath, many secular Israelis have reportedly begun revisiting faith, identity, and biblical history. In moments of national trauma, nations often return to their spiritual roots. Israel appears to be no exception.

That spiritual awakening is becoming visible inside the IDF itself.

Religious expression among soldiers has surged, particularly among younger troops shaped by war and loss. Yet that trend has also sparked conflict with Israel's secular establishment. Recently, controversy erupted after an Israeli soldier reportedly faced punishment for displaying a "Moshiach" -- Messiah -- patch on his uniform. Others have been photographed wearing patches depicting the future Temple alongside the words, "Soon in our days."

The reaction from military leadership exposed a growing tension within Israeli society.

The wording of the reprimand disturbed many religious Israelis. Israel's founding vision openly referenced the "redemption of Israel," yet soldiers expressing messianic Jewish hope can reportedly face severe punishment, while Hamas openly frames its war in explicitly religious terms. Hamas even uses the Dome of the Rock -- built atop the ruins of the ancient Jewish Temple -- as a central emblem of its movement.

To many religious Israelis, the contradiction feels glaring.

And now some rabbis are pushing for tangible action.

Rabbi Shmuel Eliyahu recently called on Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu and Israeli leadership to establish a synagogue directly on the Temple Mount as a first step toward expanded Jewish worship there. Speaking opposite the mount during Jerusalem Day events, Eliyahu declared that the Islamic structures currently standing there are tied to Israel's exile and insisted that a future Jewish Temple will one day rise again.

"In the meantime, until the Temple is built, there needs to be a synagogue here," he said. "Now the Muslims already understand that it is not theirs; we need to take hold."

Those are extraordinary words.

For many Jews, the Temple represents far more than a building. It symbolizes restoration, covenant, national redemption, and Israel fulfilling its calling to become a light to the nations. In Jewish thought, the Temple is tied deeply to the spiritual destiny of Israel itself.

But while many Jews view these developments with hope, many Christians view them with profound caution.

For generations, prophecy-minded Christians have believed a future Jewish Temple would eventually play a central role in end-times events foretold in Scripture. Passages in books like Daniel, Matthew, and 2 Thessalonians have long been interpreted by many Christians as pointing toward a future world leader -- the Antichrist -- who will enter a rebuilt temple, declare himself divine, and demand worship.

To Christians holding that view, every new discussion surrounding Temple Mount sovereignty carries spiritual weight far beyond politics.



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The Third Temple is no longer merely the subject of prophecy conferences or theological speculation. It is increasingly entering political discourse, military culture, national identity, and public activism within Israel itself.

What once sounded impossible is now openly discussed in the streets of Jerusalem.

The flags waving during Jerusalem Day were not just symbols of nationalism. For many marching beneath them, they represented a belief that history itself is moving toward fulfillment -- and that the mountain at the center of Jerusalem may soon stand at the center of the world once again.

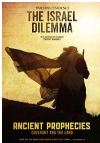
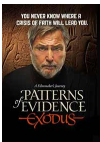
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